Backpack
The Union soldier would have carried all of the items shown, as well as many more besides, especially at the start of the war. Spare clothing, shelter, ammunition, and food rations were essentials, while soldiers also carried an assortment of personal items including photographs, a bible, and tobacco.

Folding knives
The pocket knife was the Union soldier's multipurpose tool for cutting rope and general camp work.

Cartridge box
This leather pouch held 40 cartridges, a paper tube filled with a minie ball, and black powder. Each cartridge pouch also contained a small pouch that held musket tools and cleaning patches.

Canteen
The Union soldier's canteen was made of two pieces of tin with a pewter spout and cork. The body of the canteen was covered with a cotton and wool cloth that, when wet, would help keep the water cool.

Spare cartidges
Union soldiers were usually given between 60 and 80 rounds of ammunition to carry when they were on a campaign. What would not fit into the cartridge pouch was often carried in the infantryman's pockets or backpack.

Ketchum hand grenade
Hand grenades in the mid-19th century were not all that reliable. In order to detonate they had to land on their nose. At Vicksburg in 1863 Confederate soldiers caught these grenades in blankets and threw them back at the Union soldiers.